

Apply for a Science Corps Fellowship - Entry #3223

Name

Bianca Baldassarri

Emailbiancabaldassarri2022@u.northwestern.edu**Gender**

Female

City, state, and country of residence

Italy

Nationality

Italian

When did or will you finish your PhD?

Summer 2023

University Education

PhD | Applied Physics | Northwestern University | 2023

MSci | Physics | University College London | 2016

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps fellow?

What excites me the most about the Science Corp fellowship is the opportunity to experience the joy of teaching, while leveraging my familiarity with scientific concepts, and pedagogical training, in a cultural context which I would otherwise be unlikely to be immersed in on a professional level. The experiences I have had teaching and mentoring have been some of the most fulfilling times of my PhD. While the most enjoyable and rewarding aspects have been the enriching human interactions and the tailoring of communication and feedback styles, I also have great appreciation for the deeper understanding and greater ability to contextualize that have come with breaking concepts down and approaching them from different angles. The

teaching approaches I have been exposed to in the US have enriched both my skill-set and the view of education I developed in my home country of Italy and in my UK undergrad institution. Likewise, I often observed the unique perspectives and nuances introduced in scientific and educational discussions by fellow international students. The Science Corp fellowship would represent an opportunity to make the most of this mutually enriching exchange, while allowing me to grow both personally and professionally, and to bring the skills and knowledge gained through this experience to the next steps in my career.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship.

Through the Northwestern Searle Center for Advancing Learning and Teaching I have had several opportunities to learn about and reflect on teaching ideas and techniques. I participated in workshops on inclusive teaching, and co-lead discussion sessions on effective STEM teaching, covering all stages of instruction, from course design to assessment. Serving as a TA for undergraduate physics and as a mentor for a high-school level coding course has allowed me to gain experience in both engaging the entire class at once and providing individual hands-on guidance to a large number of students, while also individualizing feedback and managing timing demands. Structuring discussion sessions and developing material for coding classes offered me the chance to put in practice some of the ideas I learned around course design, which has fueled my desire to construct an entire course in the future. Teaching, living and studying outside my country of origin has provided me with many occasions to appreciate the importance of recognizing and respecting differences in communication styles and boundaries, while still fostering meaningful and lasting connections. These have been some of the most influential experiences of my life, and I strive to continue to seek opportunities to expand my cultural awareness.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

In science education

Other

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (two year) and long-term (ten year) future.

My professional aspiration is to apply the scientific and pedagogical training I received in an impact-focused position.

Teaching is my primary interest, with the long-term goal of working in a teaching-focused role at a higher education institution, or in secondary education. In the short term, I aim to gain more pedagogical experience by participating in development programs and applying for adjunct lecturing positions. The Science Corp fellowship represents not only an excellent opportunity to gain teaching experience, but to do so in a cultural environment that can expand the scope of circumstances and discussions I can encounter, contribute to, and carry with me in the future, as well as facilitating access to future teaching positions.

The second career pathway I am interested in is pursuing my passion for sustainability and leverage my scientific background in renewable energy research in either the non-profit or the consulting space. Regardless of the role I will serve in, I strive to prioritize mentorship and communication, fostering inclusive, creative and supporting working environments where expertise can continue to grow. Being open to occupying different future roles, it's exciting to see the diverse backgrounds of previous fellows and the varied career paths they have pursued.

CV/Resume [CV_2023_SC.pdf](#)**How did you find out about Science Corps?**

University email list

Any other comments/questions?

Preferred start date: Jan 2024

Preferred sites: AST and CVIF, but I don't have a strong preference, the work at all the sites looks very interesting!

[Science Corps](#)